

Tech My Breath Away

He is the in-house Disc Jockey at one of Mumbai's hottest nightclubs. Meet 23-year-old Praveen, who loves the gadgets he uses to keep the dance floor rocking, as much as he loves music

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With a business card that reads *First Runner-Up: Times Music War of the DJs*, you'd expect this 23-year-old to have only music running through his veins. But DJ Praveen, the current in-house Disc Jockey (DJ) at the Provogue Lounge, one of the most popular nightclubs in Mumbai, not only loves the music he makes, but also the gadgets that make people groove to his tunes.

A professional DJ for well over three years now, Praveen and his partner-in-crime, best friend DJ Vivek (Winner of the *Times Music War of the DJs*), work under the banner 'Gamemaster DJs', and own some of the most high-end equipment in India.

"I was always fascinated by gadgets, and being in this profession, one has to be gadget-savvy"

Having survived an Under-Grad degree in Industrial Engineering at BVIT Belapur, Praveen also finished a formal course in DJ-ing at Joe Azaredo's school in Cuffe Parade. "I was always fascinated by gadgets, and being in this profession, one has to be gadget-savvy!" says Praveen.

A fervent passion for DJ-ing led Praveen and Vivek to invest in state-of-the-art equipment that cost nearly Rs 2.5 lakh—"all purchased in the last one year," according to Praveen.

The *piece de resistance* of their collection is the Yamaha RS7000, "which we bought in the US, and is quite a unique piece even in the DJ world." A complete editing studio, the RS7000 is portable, and can be used by DJs to compose in real-time, even during a live performance. "This is a big advantage for performing duos—Vivek and I take turns spinning, scratching, and creating tracks"

Two Denon DN S5000 CD players (digital turntables) help Praveen decide what music to play. The equipment helps him control the speed at which the tracks are played, and also sample the music before it goes live.

The DN S5000 which Denon claims "is the world's first motor driven active platter for true vinyl emulation" can playback, mix, loop, sample and apply scratch effects to tracks. Its Alpha Track (2-in-1) feature allows independent and simultaneous playback of another track from the same disc, and mixes tracks together with just one unit.



Photograph Meey Xavier

The time of his life: DJ Praveen shows off his goods before heading for the Provogue Lounge, one of Mumbai's hottest nightclubs

The DJ Devices

▶ **Denon DN S5000 CD player**—Rs 50,000

▶ **Yamaha RS7000**—Between Rs 1,00,000 and Rs 1,50,000

▶ **Technics SL 1210 MK2 turntable and stylus**—Rs 45,000

▶ **Vinyls**—Rs 1,05,000 (150 vinyls, Rs 700 each)

▶ **Pioneer HDJ 1000 headphones**—Rs 10,000

▶ **Motorola E365** (WAP-enabled, camera phone)—Rs 15,000

'Hot Disc' allows ejection of a disc during play, and have it continue for another 35 seconds. Tracks can also be looped within the Hot Disc memory for an unlimited time.

A Technics SL 1210 MK2 turntable plays Praveen's 150-strong collection of vinyls—mostly House music that is yet to hit the Indian markets. "The stylus (needle) alone costs between Rs 6,000 to Rs 8,000 and may have to be changed once a year, depending on the usage."

His WAP-enabled Motorola E365 camera phone helps Praveen stay in touch with his colleagues and studio-representatives. Praveen also owns a Yamaha MIDI keyboard "which doubles up as a synthesiser."

An assembled PC (PIII, with 512 MB RAM and a Creative sound card) runs professional music-creation software such as Sony's ACID Pro, Apple's Logic Pro, and Nuendo. Even his headphones are worth Rs 10,000. The Pioneer HDJ 1000 headphones (customised for DJs) "are the hottest headphones around"! They come with foldable arms, gold-plated wires and produce clean sound, gushes Praveen.

As the evening turns into night, young Praveen, who could just as well pass off as a college kid, morphs into the funky DJ, juggling his gadgets simultaneously, and rocking the crowds all night. ☒

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